

Avocado Chila

A protein-rich gram flour (besan) pancake folded with creamy avocado and fresh vegetables — a wholesome Indian breakfast with healthy fats and plenty of fibre.

Prep Time	Cook Time	Total Time	Servings	Difficulty
10 min	15 min	25 min	2 (4 chilas)	Easy

Ingredients

For the Chila Batter

Besan (gram flour)	1 cup (about 100 g)
Ripe avocado (for batter)	½ avocado, mashed
Onion, finely chopped	1 small
Tomato, deseeded & chopped	1 small
Green chilli, finely chopped	1 (adjust to taste)
Ginger, grated	1 tsp
Fresh coriander, chopped	2 tbsp
Ajwain (carom seeds)	¼ tsp
Turmeric powder	¼ tsp
Red chilli powder (optional)	¼ tsp
Salt	to taste (keep low)
Water	about ¾ cup
Oil (mustard / groundnut / rice bran)	2 tsp in total

For the Avocado Topping

Ripe avocado (for topping)	½ avocado
Lemon juice	1 tsp
Roasted jeera powder	a pinch
Black pepper & chaat masala	a pinch each
Hung curd (optional)	2 tbsp

How to choose a ripe avocado: it should yield slightly to gentle pressure and the small stem cap should come off easily, showing green underneath. A hard avocado can be ripened at room temperature in a paper bag for 2–3 days.

Step-by-Step Method

1 Prepare the avocado

Cut the avocado in half, remove the seed and scoop out the flesh. Mash one half to a smooth paste for the batter. Dice or lightly mash the other half, mix with lemon juice, roasted jeera, black pepper and a pinch of chaat masala, and keep aside as the topping. The lemon juice stops it from turning brown.

2 Chop the vegetables

Finely chop the onion, tomato (remove the watery seeds), green chilli and coriander, and grate the ginger. Keeping them small helps the chila stay thin and cook evenly.

3 Make the batter

Sift the besan into a mixing bowl. Add turmeric, ajwain, red chilli powder and salt. Add water a little at a time and whisk to a smooth, lump-free batter.

4 Add the avocado

Whisk the mashed avocado into the batter until fully blended. It will turn a light green colour and become creamy. Adjust with 1–2 tbsp water if needed — it should flow like dosa batter, coating the back of a spoon.

5 Add vegetables & rest

Fold in the chopped onion, tomato, green chilli, ginger and coriander. Rest the batter for 5–10 minutes so the besan absorbs the liquid and the chila becomes soft.

6 Heat the pan

Heat a non-stick or well-seasoned iron tawa on medium flame. Brush with $\frac{1}{4}$ tsp oil. Sprinkle a few drops of water — if they sizzle, the pan is ready.

7 Spread the chila

Pour one ladle of batter (about $\frac{1}{4}$ of the batter) in the centre and spread gently in circles to a 6–7 inch round. Do not spread too thin, as avocado batter is softer than a plain besan batter.

8 Cook the first side

Drizzle a few drops of oil around the edges. Cook on medium-low flame for 2–3 minutes until the top looks set and the edges lift easily and turn golden.

9 Flip & cook the other side

Flip carefully with a flat spatula and cook for another 1–2 minutes, pressing lightly, until golden spots appear. Repeat with the remaining batter, adding just a few drops of oil each time.

10 Top & serve

Spread a spoon of the avocado topping (and hung curd, if using) on each chila, fold or roll, and serve hot with mint-coriander chutney.

Approximate Nutrition (per serving = 2 chilas with topping)

Energy	Protein	Carbohydrate	Dietary Fibre	Fat	Sodium
~380 kcal	~13 g	~37 g	~11 g	~19 g	low*

Values are estimates based on standard ingredient data and will vary with avocado size, oil used and portion. *Sodium depends on the salt and chaat masala added.

Health Benefits

- **Plant protein:** besan provides good-quality vegetarian protein that keeps you full for longer.
- **Heart-friendly fats:** avocado is rich in monounsaturated fats, which support healthy cholesterol levels when they replace saturated fats in the diet.
- **High fibre:** besan, avocado and vegetables together supply fibre that supports digestion and steadier blood-sugar response.
- **Nutrient-dense:** avocado adds potassium, folate, vitamin E and vitamin K; besan adds iron and magnesium.
- **Naturally gluten-free:** suitable for people avoiding wheat or gluten (check that the besan is pure).

Dietary Guidelines

Recommended for

- Weight management — 1–2 chilas make a filling, balanced breakfast.
- Diabetes — besan has a lower glycaemic impact than refined flour; pair with curd or salad and keep to the portion advised.
- Heart health — uses minimal oil and healthy fats; keep salt low.
- Vegetarian and gluten-free diets, growing children and active adults.

Use with caution / consult your dietitian

- **Kidney disease:** avocado is high in potassium — follow your prescribed potassium limit.
- **Calorie-restricted plans:** avocado is energy-dense; use ¼ avocado per serving if needed.
- **Blood thinners (e.g. warfarin):** keep vitamin K intake consistent; do not suddenly add large amounts of avocado.
- **Allergies:** avoid if allergic to avocado, chickpea/legumes, or with latex-fruit sensitivity.
- **Sensitive digestion:** besan may cause bloating in some people; the ajwain and ginger help digestion.

Cooking Tips

- Use a ripe but not over-ripe avocado; brown or stringy flesh gives a bitter taste.
- Always rest the batter — it makes the chila softer and easier to flip.
- Keep the flame medium-low; high heat burns the outside before the centre cooks.
- If the chila breaks while flipping, the batter is too thin (add 1 tbsp besan) or the pan is not hot enough.
- Add grated paneer, tofu or sprouts to the filling to increase protein further.
- For more fibre, add grated carrot, spinach or capsicum to the batter.

Serving & Storage

- **Serve with:** mint-coriander chutney, plain curd or raita, and a cucumber-tomato salad.
- **Best time:** breakfast or an early evening meal.
- **Storage:** best eaten fresh. Batter (without vegetables) can be refrigerated in an airtight box for up to 12 hours; add avocado topping only just before serving.
- **Lunch box:** roll with topping, wrap in foil and eat within 3–4 hours.

Disclaimer: This recipe is for general wellness information only and is not a substitute for personalised medical or nutrition advice. People with medical conditions should follow the diet plan given by their doctor or dietitian.

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